

## E-VEHICLES AT RISK

**THE GOVERNMENT ISSUED** an urgent advisory to India's automobile industry on critical vulnerabilities in electric vehicles (EVs). This comes after viral videos of e-rickshaws grinding to a halt on Indian streets with misuse of Chinese app BAT-BMS. Sudhir Mehta, CMD of Pune-based e-bus maker, has warned that electric buses that rely on China for vehicle control unit and its software remain vulnerable to remote shutdown risks. "Vehicle control software fundamentally has to be sovereign. We need control of that software residing in India," says Mehta. Connected EVs can be remotely immobilised or even moved if vehicle control software or its source code is from a neighbouring country, warns Eka Mobility's Mehta.

IMAGE BY HARDIK CHHABRA/AI



## SORTING EDUCATION

**BITS PILANI-BACKED AI** ed-tech start-up sortmyprep has raised \$350,000 in a pre-seed funding round. Backers include real estate magnate Boman Irani, the chairman of Mumbai-based Rustomjee Group; Sameer Mehta, co-founder of boAt; Subrat Pani, co-founder of OneAssist; Rohini Kasturi, CEO of HG Insights; and Ranjit Pawar, APAC Head at London Stock Exchange Group. The start-up is building a vertical AI platform for school exam preparation. Its flagship product, Sorty, is a curriculum-aligned conversational AI tutor offering personalised learning, adaptive study plans, and 24x7 doubt resolution.



**₹2  
LAKH CRORE**

**INVESTMENT  
ATTRACTED UNDER  
THE PLI SCHEMES  
ACROSS 14 KEY  
SECTORS AS ON  
MARCH 31, 2026.  
THE INITIATIVE HAS  
GENERATED OVER  
1.4 MILLION JOBS**



## PLASTIC CURRENCY

**AFTER UPI AND** digital currency, Indian consumers are set for one more adventure with payment transactions. The RBI is set to roll out polymer-based notes in the denominations of ₹10 and ₹20. The finance ministry has approved a proposal for introduction of one billion pieces each of these notes for field trials and then regular issuance. The Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Ltd has issued a global expression of interest to set up a polymer substrate manufacturing facility.

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